

# CHEAT CODES For Winning BIG Before 2026 is over

## EP 333

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### Executive Summary

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Episode 333 of Victory Talk delivers Brandon Carter's four-part framework for finishing 2026 strong: fix your biology first, track and optimize your mood, schedule every hour, and use friction design to automate good habits—plus AI tool demos, supplement Q&A, and a solo market review.

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### Intro & Sponsors 1:03

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- Episode 333 of the Victory Talk Podcast, hosted by Brandon Carter
- Agenda: AI productivity updates, Q4 goal-setting strategies, money-making tips, and a market update
- **Sponsor 1 — Brandon's own free live training:**
  - Teaches how to earn \$300–\$500/day extra as an online fitness coach
  - Brandon has coached 15,000+ people in fitness business over ~9 years
  - Made his first \$1 million as an online coach and promises to show viewers how, free
  - Case study — Will (Washington DC):
    - Had a full-time job, zero prior coaching clients, small following
    - Earned \$5,940 in his first 7 days in the program (joined Aug 8)
    - Crossed \$32,000 total since Aug 8 within his first month
  - Case study — Jazz:
    - Same starting point — no followers, no coaching experience

- Hit \$8,100 that week; monthly total reached \$28,100, targeting \$35,000
- AI integration: ~90% of Brandon's YouTube editing and 80–90% of Instagram Reels are now AI-produced; will teach viewers the same workflow free
- Register via link in description
- **Sponsor 2 — "Thought Chaser" (satirical/comedic bit):** fictional repellent spray played as a joke segment; not a real product
- **Sponsor 3 — Go High Level (CRM):**
  - 30-day free trial via link in description
  - Use case: collecting leads, email/phone, SMS follow-up, client management, AI tools
  - Brandon has used it for ~30 years (hyperbolic); free bonus trainings included on sign-up

## **Caffeine as a Proxy for Ambition 12:47**

- Brandon frames daily caffeine intake as a humorous but pointed signal of how seriously someone takes success
- Breakdown by dose level:

| Daily Caffeine (mg)         | Brandon's Characterization                                                                               |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0–100 mg                    | Naps after lunch; Pinterest boards; birthday tiaras                                                      |
| 100–200 mg                  | Barely waking up; small side hustle; scared of their boss                                                |
| 200–400 mg                  | Getting dangerous; lifting weights; waking before alarm; LinkedIn presence                               |
| 500–800 mg                  | Counting in energy drinks not mg; recycling bin looks like a frat house; answering calls in the bathroom |
| 800+ mg                     | Has keys to the city; smartwatch asks if you're okay; just bought the building                           |
| 1,000+ mg (Brandon's level) | "Tired is a choice the poor make"; heart rate higher than competitors' revenue                           |

- Brandon personally has consumed 1,000+ mg/day since age ~16 (~27 years)
  - Has had EKG, echo, blood work — all clear
  - Cites Andrew Huberman as consuming 800 mg/day
- Does NOT tell viewers to copy him; says to work up gradually
- Core claim: "I have never met a single person who makes a lot of money who is not a serious caffeine addict"
- Invites viewers to drop their daily caffeine amount in comments; plans a full dedicated caffeine video

## **Cheat Code 1: Fix Your Body Chemistry First — Track Everything for 14 Days 23:59**

- **Core principle:** Everything you accomplish in life is done through your body; the body sets the ceiling on productivity and energy
  - Fix the "holes in the bucket" before adding supplements or biohacks
  - Applying productivity hacks to a dysfunctional body = pouring water into a leaky bucket
- **The 14-day tracking protocol — track ALL of the following:**
  - Sleep (hours AND quality)
  - Supplements taken
  - Food intake: calories AND macronutrients (not just quantity)
  - Workouts
  - Daily step count
  - Mood
  - Focus/concentration
- **Tools Brandon uses:**
  - **Oura Ring** — tracks sleep quality, calories burned, syncs to Apple Health
  - **Apple Watch or Whoop** — alternatives for sleep/activity tracking
  - **Claude AI or ChatGPT** — both now integrate with Apple Health; use either to log food via photo or voice
    - Brandon switched from ChatGPT to Claude mid-year when Claude added Apple Health integration; ChatGPT has since added it too
    - Workflow: photograph or verbally describe a meal → AI calculates calories and macros → running daily total maintained in conversation
    - Example meal logged by voice: "two eggs, skinless chicken thighs, five ounces honey mustard"
  - **Victory Vision Planner** — free Notion-based template in the description; syncs data from AI conversations at end of day
  - **IMood Journal app** — \$2 one-time purchase (no subscription) for mood tracking (discussed more under Cheat Code 2)
- Brandon's personal nutrition targets: protein >200g, calories <300 over maintenance (stays "close to" those markers daily)
- **Why this matters:** You cannot know what to fix until you have 14 days of data showing patterns

"Every single thing you will do or accomplish in life will be done by your body. So we want to make sure your body is at its best."

## 😊 Cheat Code 2: Track and Optimize Your Mood [34:58](#)

- Brandon has clinically diagnosed bipolar II disorder (Bipolar depression, Type 2); managed it without medication using mood tracking and environmental design
- **Why mood matters for performance:**
  - Mood affects the *quality* of everything you do — sales calls, studying, parenting, relationships

- Even doing the right actions in a bad mood produces worse results than doing them in a good mood
- "It's not just what you do, but the quality of what you do — and your mood is probably the number one thing affecting the quality of your work"
- **The mood tracking method (originated ~2006, pre-smartphone):**
  - Brandon used a small notebook with a hand-drawn graph: X-axis = time (every 2 hours from wake-up), Y-axis = mood 1–10
    - 10 = euphoric peak happiness
    - 1 = deepest despair
  - Set an alarm every 2 hours; enter a number at each interval
  - At day's end, draw the curve and calculate a **daily average**
  - The average across many days = **your baseline personality / default state**
  - Now use **IMood Journal app** (\$2 lifetime, not a subscription) for the same process digitally
- **What to do with the data:**
  - Identify mood *depressors* (things that reliably lower your score) and mood *elevators*
  - Eliminate or reduce depressors — Brandon ended relationships and fixed chronic lateness based on this data
  - Increase frequency of elevators (exercise, winning money, etc.) — but avoid unsustainable or harmful elevators (drugs, etc.)
  - As mood average rises above ~7, substances like alcohol and cannabis actually start to feel *negative*, making quitting easier organically
  - Friend example: tracked mood, realized cannabis was pulling his average down, quit without willpower battles
- **Result:** As you remove negatives and add positives, the baseline rises — your personality literally improves
- Practical timeline: repeat the 14-day tracking loop continuously, iterating toward a higher average



### **Cheat Code 3: Schedule Every Hour in Your Calendar [53:44](#)**

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- Brandon's single highest-leverage productivity advice after 27+ years of coaching in fitness, business, and personal development
- "There is nothing I can think of that will improve your life faster than planning every hour of every day in your calendar"
- Everyone who has implemented this has seen productivity spike, happiness rise, and bad habits disappear *accidentally*
- **The time audit exercise — do this first:**
  - Write down: hours of sleep per week + hours of work + hours of exercise + hours with family
  - Most men cannot answer the family question even if they claim family is their #1 priority → proves they're not actually tracking it
  - AI lookup result (via Gemini): average US father spends ~7.8 hours/week in childcare

- **Math example** (168 hours/week total):
  - Sleep 8 hrs/night = 56 hrs
  - Work 50 hrs (including commute)
  - Exercise 7 days × 1 hr = 7 hrs
  - Family time 14 hrs (double the average)
  - **Remaining: ~41 hours every week — enough for a full-time second job**
- Most people have even more free time than this when they do the audit
- Conclusion: "You don't not have time. You're just wasting it."
- **How to build the calendar — step by step using Gemini + Google Calendar:**
  - Step 1 — Open Gemini (free account); it uniquely syncs with Google Calendar (Claude/ChatGPT do not)
  - Step 2 — Tell Gemini: "I sleep every day 10 PM–6 AM. Add this as a recurring event starting today."
  - Step 3 — Tell Gemini: "I work 9 AM–5 PM, five days a week. Add as recurring."
  - Step 4 — Tell Gemini: "I work out at 7 AM for one hour, seven days a week. Add as recurring. Also add a prep block the hour before (shower, drive to gym) and a recovery block after (shower, commute to work)."
  - Step 5 — Fill remaining white space with goal-specific blocks, date nights (e.g., Friday 7–10 PM recurring, color-coded pink), family time, and even entertainment
  - Every blank hour = a bullet you can fire at a goal; you have a limited number — 24 per day, non-refillable, non-transferable
- **Side effect:** Bad habits (gaming, social media scrolling, cannabis) disappear because you simply have no unscheduled time to fill with them
  - Brandon's own story: quit cannabis and alcohol accidentally — realized he hadn't done either in months because his calendar was full; decided to stop officially
- Bruce Lee quote used: "If you love life, don't waste time, for time is what life is made of."

## **Cheat Code 4: Friction Design — Make Good Habits Easy, Bad Habits Hard**

### [1:11:37](#)

- **Core concept:** Design your environment so desired behaviors have *low friction* and undesired behaviors have *high friction*
  - You want to do MORE of something → remove barriers
  - You want to do LESS of something → add barriers
- **Friction strategies Brandon uses:**
  - **Phone in another room while working:** eliminates need for willpower to avoid social media; phone is in the bathroom charging
    - "I no longer need willpower to not check Instagram because it's in another room"
  - **Two-phone system:** one phone for communication only; a separate device exclusively for social media (used for a period)

- **iPad-only social media:** put all social apps on an iPad (ideally Wi-Fi only, no LTE) — social media is worse UX on iPad, naturally reduces scroll time
- **No junk food at home:** Brandon keeps zero ice cream in the house; to get it he'd have to go outside, get recognized, take fan photos — too much friction
- **Pre-loaded morning workflow to start work within 5 minutes of waking:**
  - Night before: mix 300 mg pre-workout supplement and set it on the counter; place glasses nearby
  - Alarm = phone across the bedroom (~20 yards away) → forces him to physically get up
  - Wake → walk to phone → put on robe + Gucci sneakers → pass bathroom → quick bathroom break → drink pre-workout → begin work session within 5 minutes
  - Zero friction between waking and working
- **Community example — Jane Caesar (High Ticket Trainer member):**
  - Full-time nurse + two young kids + husband → almost no free time
  - Friction solution: **sleeps in workout clothes** → wakes up and immediately starts lifting at home
  - Result: hit fitness AND business goals; scaled to **\$49,927 in April** (her best month, just shy of \$50K with one fewer day); already at \$12,577 by early May of following month
- **Summary of Cheat Code 4:** You don't need willpower if you engineer the environment correctly

## Supplement Stack Q&A [1:27:00](#)

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- **Creatine:**
  - Brandon takes **20 g/day** (standard recommendation is 5 g for muscle; higher doses shown to improve cognitive function)
  - Blood work confirms healthy kidneys despite 10+ years of high-dose use
  - Recommends creatine for *everyone*, including non-exercisers, for mood and cognitive benefits
- **Whey protein:**
  - Uses it for convenience and superior protein-to-calorie ratio
  - Notes whey is the #1 ingredient in baby formula — frames critics as irrational
- **Testosterone (TRT):**
  - Started just before age 40; levels were low (common decline begins at 30 for all men)
  - Has published a full documentary about his TRT use
- **Peptides currently using:**
  - Zypide, BPC-157, Mod GRF (CJC), Ipamorelin, Tesamorelin — all for natural GH stimulation
- **Cialis (tadalafil):**
  - Takes daily for ~15 years, not primarily for ED but as a **vasodilator** to improve blood flow and support muscle building
  - Cites studies showing it can extend lifespan; describes it as giving "super-soldier serum" to circulation
- **Adderall and Modafinil:**

- Has prescriptions for both; uses sparingly for high-output sessions
- Calls both "highly addictive" — reserves them for emergencies only
- **Vitamins:** Vitamin C, Vitamin D (mentioned briefly)
- **Caffeine:** 1,000+ mg/day (centerpiece, discussed extensively above)
- **GLP-1 peptides:** mentioned in passing as part of current stack
- Disclaimer repeated multiple times: "Talk to your doctor before doing any of this."

## Solo Market Update 1:36:44

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- First time doing a solo market review (co-host Greg got SEC certification, started his own fund, and is restricted from public commentary)
- Brandon uses **weekly chart** timeframes primarily; does swing trading on stocks/ETFs and intraday trading on futures
- **S&P 500:**
  - Just below all-time highs; sentiment appears bullish
  - Warning: only a small number of stocks are driving the index higher — breadth is narrow
- **Russell 2000 (IWM ~\$275):**
  - Still in an uptrend on the weekly chart
  - Key level to watch: **\$275** — staying above it supports the bullish trend
- **Apple (AAPL):**
  - Hit or matched all-time highs this week, then pulled back sharply — forms a doji/inverted hammer candle
  - Still in a strong uptrend on the daily chart
  - Brandon's take: for a 10-year horizon, dollar-cost-average in; for a swing trade, buy the breakout above resistance (~\$333 level mentioned)
  - Bullish catalyst: new iPhone 17 Pro Max released; M5 Mac Studio coming; foldable iPhone announced
  - Apple has outsized weight in S&P 500 — its strength partially explains the index being near ATH while Russell lags
- **Meta Platforms (META):**
  - Had been in a symmetrical triangle / ascending pennant on the weekly chart
  - Broke out strongly; up ~14% from the pattern
  - Brandon would wait for a pullback, possibly to ~**\$660** before adding
  - Catalyst: new Meta AI platform "Muse" (compared to a personalized chatbot); new Ray-Ban smart glasses with AI integration; new VR headset release
  - Brandon's macro AI thesis: Meta and Google are better positioned than OpenAI/Anthropic because they already have massive distribution (Instagram, WhatsApp, YouTube) and monetize via ads — they don't *need* to profit directly from AI
- **Crude Oil (~\$160/barrel):**
  - Elevated due to ongoing Iran conflict and Strait of Hormuz shipping concerns

- Impacts everything; Brandon won't short NASDAQ or S&P while this is unresolved
- **XLE (Energy ETF):**
  - Was a big winner for the community previously
  - Concern: price making higher highs but **volume declining** — Brandon is cautious, may look for better setups
- **TSM (TSMC):**
  - On the watchlist due to US-China chip talks; China wants more advanced chips — key geopolitical overhang
  - Chinese AI models (Kimi, GLM) competitive with second-tier Western models (Gemini, some GPT-4 variants) but not yet top-tier (Claude Opus, Grok latest)
- **Macro concern:** Iran conflict still active; GDP and unemployment data trending worse; stock market is the one metric that has improved under current administration

## **Victory Trades Community Recap 1:53:29**

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- Victory Trades is Brandon's live trading community; link in description
- Trades live every morning: futures intraday + swing trade alerts
- Brandon shares his screen live; team also shares theirs
- **Sample results shown from community chat:**
  - Jimmy: +\$3,000 on a morning futures session
  - Butterfly SPX trade alert: member made ~\$200–300 in one day
  - Eric: +\$150 on an alerted trade
  - Trevor (22nd of the month): opened a position for \$25, closed at a **305,000% gain** (one of the announced swing trade alerts)
  - Separate trade: +400% on another alert
  - Mike — Apple options trade: +129%, +\$500
  - GSF trade member: four separate wins of \$40, \$40, \$40, \$150 across two days
  - Dawson: -\$80 loss on one trade, then +10% recovery
  - Bri (co-trader): made \$4,690 in a single morning futures session after Brandon had already logged off
- Community trades both **futures** (intraday) and **options** (swing alerts)
- Brandon's self-assessment: better futures trader than options trader; relies on options specialists in the group for those alerts
- Broadcast schedule: every Tuesday and Thursday at 5:30–6:00 PM